

ISAAC QI

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Animal welfare; geospatial analysis; applied microeconomics.

EDUCATION

University of British Columbia

Master of Science, Animal Welfare Program, Faculty of Land and Food Systems

Expected 2028

Vancouver, BC, Canada

- Funded by the NSERC Canada Graduate Scholarship – Master's (CGRS-M).

University of British Columbia

Master of Food and Resource Economics (MFRE)

August 2026

Vancouver, BC, Canada

- One-year course-based program combining academic knowledge and practical experience to address economic challenges in climate, food, and environmental sectors.
- **Relevant Coursework:** Econometrics, Time Series Analysis, Machine Learning, Environmental Economics, Policy Analysis, Economic Analysis of Agri-Food Markets
- **GPA:** 4.28/4.33

China Agricultural University

Artificial Intelligence-Empowered Animal Welfare Summer Program

July 2026

Beijing, China

- Cultural exchange with CAU faculty in engineering, animal science, and agricultural technologies.

University of British Columbia

Bachelor of Science, Applied Animal Biology

May 2024

Vancouver, BC, Canada

- **Thesis:** Transitioning dairy cows to automatic milking: predictive effects of training on post-transition AMS use.

SKILLS

- **Languages & Software:** R, SAS, Python, Google Earth Engine, LaTeX, HTML, CSS, Power BI
- **Econometric Methods:** Mixed Effects Models, Panel Data Analysis, Regression Analysis, Instrumental Variables, Time Series Analysis, Machine Learning
- **Applied Data & Policy Analysis:** Geospatial Modeling, Cost-Benefit Analysis, Policy Analysis Matrix

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

UBC Sustainability Hub & Metro Vancouver

Sustainability Scholar

May 2026 - August 2026

Vancouver, Canada

- Identifying upstream flood attenuating natural ecosystems and downstream beneficiary communities in the Lower Fraser region through geospatial analysis.

Animal Welfare Program, Faculty of Land and Food Systems, UBC

Research Assistant to Dr. Dan Weary & Dr. Marina von Keyserlingk

May 2023 - August 2026

Vancouver, Canada

- Identified novel behavioral responses in dairy cows transitioning to automated milking systems.
- Estimated mixed effects models in R analyzing individual heterogeneity and time-varying dairy cow behaviour.

AI Evaluator

Mercor Intelligence

2024 - Present

Remote

- Senior RLHF reviewer and rubric designer.

- Domain expert in agriculture, economics, and mathematics for AI model evaluation and prompt refinement.

PUBLICATIONS & CONFERENCES

C=CONFERENCE, J=JOURNAL, S=IN SUBMISSION

- [S.1] Qi, I., Heinsius, J., von Keyserlingk, M.A.G., & Weary, D.M. (in submission). Individual differences in training predict how well dairy cows adjust to automatic milking.
- [C.1] Qi, I., Heinsius, J., & Weary, D.M. (2024). Teaching Cows to Udder-stand Robots: Positive Reinforcement Training for Automatic Milking System Acclimation. *LFS Graduate Student Conference*. University of British Columbia, Vancouver, BC.
- [C.2] Qi, I., Vandresen, B., & Weary, D.M. (2024). Public Perception of Genetic Engineering in Production Cattle Analyzed using YouTube Data. *UBC Multidisciplinary Undergraduate Research Conference*. University of British Columbia, Vancouver, BC.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

• Graduate Facilitator Centre for Teaching, Learning and Technology (CTLT), UBC ◦ Facilitate pedagogical development workshops for graduate students on effective teaching practices.	2026 - Present
• Graduate Teaching Assistant APBI 398 - Research Methods in Applied Biology - Dr. Dan Weary & Dr. Marina von Keyserlingk	2026 - Present
• Graduate Teaching Assistant DSCI 551 - Descriptive Statistics and Probability for Data Science - UBC Master of Data Science	2026 - Present
• Graduate Teaching Assistant DSCI 552 - Statistical Inference and Computation I - UBC Master of Data Science	2026 - Present
• Graduate Teaching Assistant LFS 101 - Principles of Microeconomics with Applications to Land and Food Systems - Dr. Sumeet Gulati	2026
• Graduate Teaching Assistant DSCI 532 - Data Visualization II - UBC Master of Data Science	2026
• Graduate Teaching Assistant FNH 415 - Business Concepts in Food, Nutrition, and Health - Dr. Karen Taylor	2025
• Research Mentor APBI 398 - Research Methods in Applied Biology	2024
• Teaching Assistant Machine Learning and AI Workshop - Vancouver Independent School for Science and Technology (VISST)	2024
• Undergraduate Teaching Assistant APBI 314 - Animals in Society - Dr. Amelia MacRae	2024

SCHOLARSHIPS & AWARDS

TOTAL FUNDING: ~\$34,300 CAD (APPROX.)

• CGRS-M – NSERC Award Natural Sciences and Engineering Research Council of Canada	2026 \$27,000 CAD
• China Link Scientific Exchange Scholarship China Scholarship Council & China Agricultural University	2026 ¥7,750 CNY
• CAES Conference Scholarship Canadian Agricultural Economics Society, UBC MFRE	2026 \$2,250 CAD
• John and Mary Young Scholarship Faculty of Land and Food Systems, UBC – LFS Department Award	2026 \$700 CAD
• UBC TSC Legacy Award UBC Thunderbird Sport Clubs	2026
• Academic Thunderbird Award University of British Columbia	2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
• MFRE Award: Land and Food Systems Professional Programs Award University of British Columbia	2025 \$1,000 CAD
• UBC TSC Student Leadership Award UBC Thunderbird Sport Clubs	2025
• Best Project: Web Design Cursor.ai	2025 \$300 CAD
• AI for Animals Conference Scholarship AI for Animals	2025 \$150 USD
• Lululemon Leadership Award Lululemon	2024 \$1,200 CAD
• Canadian Society of Animal Science Undergraduate Award Canadian Society of Animal Science	2024 \$100 CAD
• 3rd Place Poster Presentation Award LFS Graduate Student Conference	2024 \$75 CAD

SERVICE TO THE UNIVERSITY

- **LFS Graduate Student Council** 2025 - Present
Faculty of Land and Food Systems, UBC
 - **Treasurer & Applied Animal Biology Representative** 2026 - Present
 - **Academic Events Coordinator & MFRE Program Representative** 2025 - 2026
 - * Led the organization of the LFS Graduate Student Conference; coordinated sponsorships, logistics, and academic teams.
 - * Secured 12 sponsors totalling \$2,000 in funding; supported 100 attendees and 50 presenters.
- **President** 2023 - 2024
UBC Pre-Veterinary and Animal Welfare (PAW) Club
 - Engaged in international collaborations with veterinary schools around the world.
 - Led animal welfare outreach activities for 100+ undergraduate students.
- **Chair** June - October, 2023
Animal Welfare Conference
 - Directed UBC PAW's flagship Animal Welfare Conference with 11 expert speakers

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY SERVICE

- **Notion Campus Leader** 2026 - Present
Notion
 - Selected as UBC's representative in Notion's national Campus Leader program, developing templates and supporting adoption across the student community.
- **Proctor** 2026 - Present
Mensa Canada
 - Proctor for Mensa Canada's standardized entrance examinations.
- **Senior Girls Basketball Coach** 2013 - Present
Vancouver School Board
 - Designed and executed player development programs for approximately 200 athletes over the past decade.
- **Captain & Finance Officer** 2023 - 2026
UBC Thunderbird Sports Club Quadball
 - Rebuilt team culture, grew active roster from four remaining players to nineteen within a single season; secured #1 in universities and #1 in the west at 2026 Championships.
 - John David Nicholson Spirit Award recipient.
- **Board Member** 2024 - 2026
Quadball Canada
 - Represented Western Canada and the university division, advised on national growth strategy.

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- **Facilitator Development Workshop** June, 2026
UBC CTLT & CIRTL Network
- **CIRTL SoTL Workshop** May, 2026
UBC CTLT & CIRTL Network
- **Instructional Skills Workshop** October, 2025
UBC CTLT & CIRTL Network
- **PAACO Dairy Welfare Auditing Workshop** April, 2024
Modesto, CA

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages: English (Native), Mandarin (Fluent)